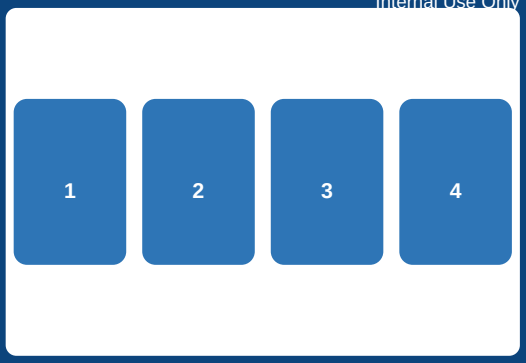
MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS

Internal Use Only

Deviation of Standard Procedure

Manage and investigate deviations from documented standards to understand why they occur and permanently



WHEN TO USE

Whenever a team member does not follow the defined procedure — whether by mistake, necessity, or choice.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Detect and document the deviation immediately: what, where, when, who, and what actually happened
2. Determine immediate impact on safety, quality, or delivery, and contain if necessary
3. Investigate root cause: Was the standard unclear? Training insufficient? Standard incorrect? Environment unsuitable?
4. Take corrective action at root cause level — retrain, update the standard, or redesign the process
5. Verify within 30 days that the deviation has not recurred

PRACTITIONER TIP

! Most deviations reveal a problem with the standard or the system, not the person. Approach every deviation with curiosity, not blame.

KEY OUTPUTS

- Deviation record with investigation
- Root cause and corrective action documentation
- Updated standard or training record where applicable

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

Deviation frequency trend; % with root cause investigation completed; recurrence rate at 30 days

TOOL CATEGORY

Management Systems